

JULIA KASANZEWA

BACKEND DEVELOPER & FOUNDER



PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software engineer and founder with 5+ years of experience in backend development, specialising in scalable system architecture, API development, and full-stack product delivery. Holds a B.Sc. in Computer Science and an M.Eng. in Print and Media Technology (BHT Berlin), providing a strong cross-disciplinary foundation in software engineering, digital media, and user-centred product design. Demonstrated ability to lead cross-functional development teams, manage end-to-end project lifecycles using Agile and Scrum methodologies, and deliver production-grade applications across web and mobile platforms. Complementary expertise in digital marketing strategy, e-commerce development, content production, and brand strategy, acquired through the independent founding and operation of a digital wellness brand. Currently seeking part-time opportunities in software development, digital marketing, or wellness technology where technical precision and strategic thinking can deliver measurable impact.

SKILLS

Backend & Systems Engineering

JavaScript, Node.js, Express.js, REST API Design, MVC Architecture, Clean Architecture, Domain-Driven Design (DDD), Microservices, Python, Java, C#, Bash/Shell Scripting

Frontend & Full-Stack Development

JavaScript, TypeScript, Next.js, Vue.js, HTML, CSS, API Integration, State Management, Responsive Design

Data & Infrastructure

PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Sequelize, Data Modeling & Normalization, XML Data Structuring

Cloud, DevOps & Testing

Docker, AWS S3, CI/CD Pipelines, Git (GitHub, GitLab), Jenkins, Linux, Rancher, Kibana, OpenAPI/Swagger, Mocha.js, Chai.js, JUnit, Selenium, k6

AI & Applied Machine Learning

CoreML, CreateML, Vision Framework, On-Device ML Inference, Image Classification, Model Training & Evaluation

Product Development & Systems Thinking

API-first Product Design, Scalable Architecture, Automation Workflows, Database-Driven Systems, Cross-Media & Publishing Systems

Founder & Business Skills

Lean Startup, Business Model Canvas, Market Sizing (TAM/SAM/SOM), Customer Segmentation, UX Testing, Innovation Strategy, Investment Calculation (NPV, ROI)

Marketing & Growth Stack

WordPress, WooCommerce, Stripe, Metricool, HubSpot, ActiveCampaign, MailChimp, ManyChat

Design & Prototyping

Figma, Adobe XD, Canva, Wireframing, HCI

Tools & Productivity

ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, Cursor, Notion AI, Warp Terminal, Descript, ElevenLabs

Development Environments

Visual Studio Code, IntelliJ IDEA, Eclipse, Xcode

Languages

German (Native), Russian (Native), English (Fluent)

CONTACT

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EDUCATION

- 2017 - 2022** **BHT UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES BERLIN**
Computer Science (B.Sc.)
- 2019** **INTERNATIONAL EXCHANGE SEMESTER (ERASMUS+) AT INSTITUTO SUPERIOR DE ENGENHARIA DO PORTO (ISEP)**
Computer Science (B.Sc.)
- 2021** **INSTITUT TRANZENDENTALE MEDIZIN BERLIN**
Intensive Course: Hypnosis Practitioner
- 2022 - 2025** **BHT UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES BERLIN**
Print and Media Technology (M.Eng.)
- 2025 - 2026** **EXIST WOMEN FOUNDER PROGRAM SCHOLARSHIP RECIPIENT**
Selective government-funded accelerator programme for female-led tech startups; includes business coaching, strategic mentorship, innovation workshops, and seed funding access.

EDUCATIONAL PROJECTS - COMPUTER SCIENCE (B. SC.), BHT BERLIN

- 2020** **University Project: Online Shop**
BACKEND DEVELOPER & SCRUM MASTER
- Led a diverse team of 5 as Scrum Master using GitLab, ensuring sprint delivery and team coordination
 - Maintained code stability and best practices with Git; mentored junior team members
 - Built a backend using Node.js, Express, MySQL, and Sequelize to power CRUD functionality
 - Applied MVC architecture for modular and scalable project structure
 - Integrated EJS middleware to support frontend development
- Swift App Projects**
- Developed interactive iOS apps using Views, Geolocation API, and standard UI components
 - Applied design patterns including Delegation and State Machines
 - Built and tested in Xcode using debugging tools
 - Worked with Moya and implemented Clean Swift Architecture
- 2022** **Bachelor Thesis: Development of an AI Artwork Guide for iOS Devices**
- Designed and implemented a native iOS application that uses on-device machine learning to identify artworks and display curated information to users, with a focus on museum visitors and tourists
 - Built a modular app architecture (MVVM) using Swift, SwiftUI, and Xcode, enabling clear separation of logic, UI, and data handling for maintainability and testability
 - Trained a custom image classifier using Apple CreateML, based on a curated dataset of 19 artworks from MoMA. The model achieved over 80% accuracy under real-world conditions
 - Used Apple's Vision framework for real-time object detection, rectangle recognition, and camera stream handling, allowing users to scan artworks naturally via their device
 - Integrated CoreML for low-latency, offline AI inference to ensure smooth performance without requiring internet access — optimizing for speed and privacy
 - Designed a minimalist, user-friendly interface using SwiftUI, requiring minimal user input and providing immediate feedback
 - Conducted performance testing under various lighting and distance conditions to refine model responsiveness and usability
 - Documented the full development process, data architecture, UI/UX rationale, testing methodology, and AI integration pipeline in a technical thesis using LaTeX
 - Version-controlled the project with GitLab, organizing codebase, iterations, and development milestones

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EDUCATIONAL PROJECTS – PRINT AND MEDIA TECHNOLOGY (M. ENG.), BHT BERLIN

- 2022 Created a university magazine as a cohort project: wrote articles, designed layouts, coordinated print production — strengthening cross-functional project execution and editorial workflows
- Team Lead & Videographer** for a client image video (casablanca gGmbH): led a 4-person team from concept to final video, covering scripting, filming, editing
- Developed a **marketing campaign for CrowdFarming**, collaborating in a 4-person team on digital brand strategy and visual identity
- 2023 Designed a **gamified waste collection app** with a focus on sustainability, combining design thinking and product prototyping
- Developed a **lead magnet marketing concept** and implemented it using **WordPress**
- Co-created and taught a **user interface design class using Adobe XD**, including creating all mockups and materials; taught 15 Bachelor's students hands-on design practices
- Built a **wellbeing AI app concept** using **Adobe XD**, **Illustrator**, and AI tools like **Descript** and **ElevenLabs**, including a unique voice interface — demonstrating early-stage product development and creative AI integration
- 2024 **Master Thesis: Lean Startup as a Tool for the Successful Development of a Social Media Lifestyle Brand on Instagram**
- Developed and executed a full 3-month growth strategy for a self-built Instagram brand, applying lean startup methodology in a real-world context
 - Conducted **competitor benchmarking**, **persona-based user research**, and **trend analysis** to inform product-market fit and brand positioning
 - Used **Metricool** and **HubSpot** to design and track content calendars, growth funnels, and **key performance indicators (KPIs)**
 - Performed detailed KPI evaluation and **data-driven iteration cycles** to optimize reach, engagement, and conversion
 - Designed and produced social-first multimedia content using **CapCut**, **Final Cut Pro**, and **native Instagram tools**
 - Gained hands-on experience in **brand-building**, **audience psychology**, and **digital campaign testing**, merging creative and analytical approaches
 - Demonstrated strong **ownership**, **cross-functional thinking**, and ability to prototype, test, and optimize content-driven digital products independently

KEY LEARNINGS & APPLIED FRAMEWORKS FROM THE EXIST WOMEN PROGRAM

- 2025 Completed a 12-month founder qualification program focused on venture validation, market testing, product development, and investor readiness.

Key competencies developed:

- Customer discovery, assumption testing, and validation research
- Problem-solution fit and value proposition development
- Pitch structuring, strategic messaging, and presentation training
- Public speaking deep dive and hands-on training at different events
- Market sizing (TAM/SAM/SOM), pricing, and financial planning
- Intellectual property basics, startup law, and digital asset protection
- Fundraising preparation, investor communication, and data room readiness
- UX testing, rapid prototyping, and iterative product development
- Distribution-first thinking and go-to-market validation
- Sustainability-driven innovation, systems thinking, and business model design

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WORK EXPERIENCE

12/2020-
01/2025

Nanocosmos GmbH – Interactive Streaming
IOS & BACKEND DEVELOPER

- Contributed to the development of a high-performance interactive streaming platform, working across backend services, REST APIs, and iOS features within a microservices environment
- Designed and maintained scalable backend features using Node.js, Express.js, PostgreSQL, and Sequelize, ensuring clean architecture and system reliability
- Improved legacy systems by refactoring Sequelize queries and aligning the codebase with modern standards to boost performance and maintainability
- Collaborated closely with cross-functional teams (product, design, frontend) to deliver user-focused, production-ready features
- Participated in agile development cycles, conducted code reviews, and upheld internal quality standards and Git best practices
- Supported and extended the CI/CD pipeline using Docker, Jenkins, and AWS, contributing to automated deployment, service scaling, and environment separation
- Performed backend and performance testing using Mocha.js, Chai.js, and k6, and handled cross-browser and integration testing with Selenium and BrowserStack
- Used Swagger (OpenAPI) to document and test backend endpoints
- Monitored and debugged live systems using Kibana Dashboards, identifying performance bottlenecks and analyzing real-time logs
- Worked with AWS S3 for cloud asset storage and environment configuration
- Contributed to native iOS development using Swift and Objective-C, building and debugging UI components in Xcode and integrating internal SDKs
- Used Rancher for managing containerized applications in the cloud and coordinated deployment workflows
- Built internal APIs for managing user and campaign data, enabling seamless integration with ActiveCampaign to automate email workflows and link backend logic to marketing journeys
- Actively contributed to internal tooling, documentation, and API development across staging and production environments in the nanoStream Cloud ecosystem

09/2026-
11/2026

Rad-Börse
IT & MARKETING STRATEGIST

- Planned and developed complete website from scratch: wireframed layouts, defined site architecture, and selected WordPress + Hetzner stack for performance/scalability
- Installed/configured WordPress on Hetzner hosting: SSL certificates, DNS setup, security hardening, automated backups, and 99.9% uptime infrastructure
- Customized Kadence theme with Gutenberg/Kadence Blocks: responsive design for all devices, custom product pages (E-bikes, used bikes, MTB), service sections, galleries
- Implemented SEO: local keywords ("Fahrrad Erfurt"), meta titles/descriptions, XML sitemap, schema markup, canonical tags for top local rankings
- Integrated Google My Business reviews/maps plus social media links and share buttons for enhanced trust and referral traffic
- Built conversion-focused WPForms contact/lead forms, image optimization, caching plugins, lazy loading for Core Web Vitals compliance
- Designed marketing funnel: strategic CTAs, FAQ pages, testimonial carousels, service advantage lists for higher inquiries
- Ensured full GDPR compliance: custom Impressum/Datenschutz pages, cookie consent banners, privacy policy integration across site
- Set up Google Analytics 4, Search Console, performance monitoring, heatmaps for data-driven CRO and continuous marketing optimization
- Mobile-first responsive design, cross-browser testing (Chrome, Safari, Firefox)
- Delivered end-to-end project: from discovery call to live launch, blending technical development, SEO expertise, UX design, and growth marketing strategy

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BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT & INDEPENDENT VENTURES

01/2026 - Present @juliakasanzeva — Women's Direct-to-Consumer Wellness Brand | Subconscious Healing & Emotional Resilience
FOUNDER & LEAD STRATEGIST | JULIAKAS.DE | @JULIAKASANZEWA (INSTAGRAM & YOUTUBE)

- **Brand Architecture & Strategic Positioning:** Founding and scaling a digital-first wellness brand dedicated to helping high-achieving women overcome anxious attachment and financial scarcity blocks through somatic healing and subconscious identity reprogramming; developed a cohesive, premium visual identity system and overarching business strategy across Instagram, YouTube, and the brand website, supported by the EXIST Women Founder Program
- **Market Research & Product-Market Fit:** Executed comprehensive quantitative and qualitative market research utilising Lean Startup methodologies and the "Customer-First Blueprint" framework; defined the Total Addressable Market (TAM) within the \$10B+ global mental wellness sector; engineered a detailed B2C buyer persona based on demographic, psychographic, and behavioural segmentation to inform targeted product development and messaging strategy
- **Product Development & Digital Commerce:** Architected a scalable digital product ecosystem, including the conceptualisation, scripting, and production of 7-day and 30-day audio-guided hypnosis programmes targeting specific psychological and emotional patterns in the areas of attachment, self-worth, and financial mindset; designed, developed, and currently managing a proprietary e-commerce platform built on WordPress and WooCommerce, with integrated payment processing via Stripe, PayPal, and Google Pay
- **Digital Marketing & Funnel Automation:** Engineered and implemented high-converting sales funnels and automated marketing workflows; deployed ManyChat for sophisticated Instagram DM automation sequences, converting organic engagement into measurable lead generation; building structured email marketing sequences (welcome flows, waitlists, and product upsell funnels) to nurture prospects from initial acquisition through to conversion
- **Multi-Platform Content Strategy & Production:** Designed and executing a data-driven, multi-pillar content strategy (Mindset · Relationships · Performance) across Instagram, YouTube, and TikTok; independently managing the full production lifecycle — from hook-engineered scripting and filming to advanced post-production — using Descript, Final Cut Pro, Premiere Pro, and CapCut; applying retention-first principles including structured narrative arcs, SEO-optimised titling, and strategic call-to-action placement
- **Analytics & Performance Optimisation:** Directing cross-platform growth strategy using VidIQ and KeywordsEverywhere for YouTube SEO, keyword research, and audience behaviour analysis; continuously analysing engagement metrics, retention curves, and conversion data via Metricool, Instagram Insights, and native platform analytics to iteratively optimise content performance and audience targeting
- **Operations & Systems Architecture:** Developed a centralised operational infrastructure in Notion, including a dynamic Social Media Content Tracker (with Content Pipeline, Content Calendar, Film Calendar, Campaign Tracker, and Repurposing views), financial planning dashboards, and a Business Model Canvas; managing all business operations independently as a sole founder
- **Visual Identity & Content Design:** Independently created all brand visuals — including thumbnails, cover designs, Story templates, and feed aesthetics — using Canva; applied design psychology principles to ensure visual consistency across all platforms, and integrated mobile-first editing workflows to maintain a cohesive, premium brand aesthetic at scale
- **E-Commerce & Web Development:** Designed, launched, and currently managing a fully custom e-commerce platform (juliakas.de) built on WordPress and WooCommerce; architected the site structure (Home, Shop, Freebies for the lead funnel) to optimise user journey from content consumption to product conversion; integrated secure, multi-currency payment gateways including Stripe, PayPal, and Apple & Google Pay; and implemented native email capture forms to build and nurture a direct-to-consumer subscriber list.
- **Customer Research & Business Model Development:** Conducted qualitative audience interviews and structured market research to validate core assumptions and identify key pain points; deployed an Instagram-to-email feedback loop, using audience polls, DM responses, and subscriber surveys, to iteratively test hypnosis content (MVP) and refine product-market fit in real time; developed and iterated a Business Model Canvas — mapping customer segments, value propositions, revenue streams, and cost structures — to systematically sharpen brand positioning within the women's wellness and subconscious healing market
- **Hypnosis Script Development & Applied Research:** Building on an existing **Hypnosis Practitioner** certification, conducted extensive independent research into subconscious reprogramming, nervous system regulation, and attachment theory to inform all programme content; authored full hypnosis scripts designed to target deep subconscious mind states, drawing on evidence-based principles of trance induction, identity rewiring, and somatic healing
- **Audio Production & Sound Design:** Recorded all hypnosis sessions in-house using own voice, with **ElevenLabs** applied for AI-assisted audio refinement; composed and produced original meditation music and soundscapes in **Logic Pro** — delivering a complete, self-produced end-to-end production pipeline from scripting through to final audio mastering

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